

Zhihong Li

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Education

- 2026 - 2027 **University of Oxford** (incoming, October 2026)
M.A. in Sociology, expected 2027
- 2022 - 2026 **Zhejiang University**
B.A. in Communication; GPA: 4.09/4.30 (WES GPA: 3.93/4.00).
Thesis: When the Platform Defines “Women’s Growth”: The Boundaries of Discourse, Identity Substitution and Platformized Feminism
- Summer 2024 **University of Chicago**
Data and Policy Summer Scholar Program
Completed quantitative policy analysis coursework using R; certificate score: 95.

Publications

- [1] Zou, W., Qu, J. G., Yi, J., & **Li, Z.** (2026). Addressing “Political Anger” and “Non-Political Fear” in News Engagement: The Impact of Human-AI Interactions on Emotional and Behavioral Responses. *Mass Communication and Society*, 1-21.

Conference Presentations

- [4] Qin, X., **Li, Z.**, & Cheng, X. (2026). Restoring Heterogeneity in LLM Social Simulation: An Audience Segmentation Approach. Presented at the Annual Conference of the *International Communication Association (ICA)*, Computational Methods Division, Cape Town, South Africa.
- [3] **Li, Z.** (2026). “Only a Method of Getting to Know Someone”: Gay University Students, Heteronormativity, and the Mediatization of Love on Chinese Dating Apps. Presented at the Annual Conference of the *International Communication Association (ICA)*, Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender and Queer Studies Division, Cape Town, South Africa.
- [2] **Li, Z.** (2026). Feeling the Collapse: Fandom Meltdowns as Reactive Collective Action in the Digital Movement Society. Presented at the Annual Conference of the *International Communication Association (ICA)*, Popular Media and Culture Division, Cape Town, South Africa.

- [1] Zou, W., Qu, J. G., Yi, J., & Li, Z. (2025). Addressing “Political Anger” and “Non-Political Fear” in News Engagement: The Impact of Human-AI Interactions on Emotional and Behavioral Responses. Presented at the Annual Conference of the *Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)*, Political Communication Division, San Francisco, CA, United States.

Selected Works in Progress

- [3] Qin, X., Li, Z., & Cheng, X. (2026). Restoring heterogeneity in LLM-based social simulation: An audience segmentation approach. *arXiv*.
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2604.06663>
- [2] Li, Z., & Yi, J. (2026). When Women’s Growth Is Platformed: Disentangling Platform Architecture and Feminist Publicness. Manuscript submitted to *Feminist Media Studies*.
- [1] Li, Z. (2026). Fandom Rupture in the Movement Society: Reactive Collective Participation Through Affective Practices. Manuscript submitted to *Social Media + Society*.

Research Experiences

- 2025 **Enterprise Survey for Innovation and Entrepreneurship in China, Peking University**
Survey Development Assistant
 Coordinated questionnaire design, review, and digitalization; piloted the survey system and provided real-time technical support during large-scale fieldwork.
- 2024 - 2025 **Research on Temporal Representation and User Time Perception of Mini-Games**
Project Leader · Zhejiang University Student Research Training Program
 Led focus-group interviews and participant observation with mini-game users; synthesized findings into a full research report on the shaping of media time.
- 2024 **A Comparative Study of Cultural Elements and Types in International Cities**
Group Leader
 Reviewed international research, developed indicators of urban cultural elements, and derived city typologies through comparative analysis.
- 2024 **Academy of Social Governance, Zhejiang University**
Investigator · Social Governance Index Research
 Supported county-level desk research, indicator data collection, and statistical analysis; contributed to the 2024 Social Governance Top 100 Counties release and seminar.

- 2024 **Institute of Social Science Survey, Peking University**
Interviewer · Chinese Family Panel Studies (CFPS)
Conducted field interviews and questionnaire surveys in Hangzhou for longitudinal research on social and economic development, education, and health.

Honors & Awards

- 2025 **Third Prize, Student Academic Paper Competition**
College of Media and International Culture, Zhejiang University
- 2023 **Zhejiang University Third-Class Scholarship**
Zhejiang University
- 2023 **Zhejiang University Academic Excellence Pioneer**
Zhejiang University

Related Skills

Programming

R (Proficient), SPSS (Proficient), Python (Intermediate).

Languages

Mandarin (Native); English (Proficient, TOEFL 109, GRE 328).